Sorghum

A grainy dice-rolling, deck builder for 2-5 players.

You never intended to be a humble millet farmer forever. You have dreams. Millet may have been good enough for your old man but not for you. You're expanding the operation: spelt, durum, khorasan. Some windmills recently came onto the market, and you've half a mind to mill your own flour. And why shouldn't you?

Unfortunately, your competition have the same ideas and there's only so much farmland to go around.

Overview

Purchase grain fields and windmills. Produce then mill grain into flour. Fields, grain, and flour all get you points. Once all grain fields have been purchased, the game ends and the player with the most victory points wins.

Components

- 6 millet field cards
- 18 grain field cards
- 15 windmill cards
- 60 grain/flour cards
- 3 white D6s
- 1 black D6 (the mill die)
- 40-50 money tokens (e.g. pennies)

Setup

1. Arrange grain field cards face up, ordered by price (i.e. $ amount in top right corner).
2. Arrange grain/flour cards in 4 piles by grade, grain side up.
3. Shuffle windmills in a single pile, face up.
4. Deal all players a random millet field card. Put the remaining millets away.
5. Establish the bank by putting money tokens in a pile.

Gameplay

Turns consist of 4 phases performed sequentially: **Buy**, **Harvest**, **Mill**, and **Crop Rotation**. The **Buy** phase is only available to the active player but the **Harvest**, **Mill**, and **Crop Rotation** phases apply to everyone and may be performed concurrently.

Buy

During the buy phase, the active player may either purchase 1 grain field card or 1 windmill. Grain field cards have a flat cost next to their title, e.g. SPELT $1. Windmills have a progressive cost: the 1st cost $2, the 2nd cost $5, and the 3rd cost $8. You may not buy more than 3 windmills.

Harvest

The active player rolls all four D6s. All players resolve harvest actions for their purchased grain fields. For each non-fallow field, check to see if the condition on the field matches the 4 dice. If so, gain the money indicated on the bottom left of the field card, and then, unless the field already has a cached grain, cache a grain on that field with the indicated grade. A field's grain must be milled before you can cache another grain on it.

Grain/flour card scarcity is not a mechanic in Sorghum. If you run out of a specific grade you may print out/make more copies.

Mill

If the mill die (aka the black die) matches any player's purchased windmill, that player may mill any 1 cached grain from one of their fields by moving it to the corresponding windmill, then flipping the grain over, turning it to flour. Windmills can hold unlimited flour.

Crop Rotation

All players check each of their fields, if any of the four D6 matches the fallow or unfallow condition (see bottom right of field), flip that field card over.

Millet fields are not affected by crop rotation until you have 4 or more fields.

After all players have resolved all phases, the active player rotates clockwise.

End of Game

The game ends after the turn that buys the final field finishes.

Scoring

Add up all points printed on each card's top left corner.

Flour: flour cards on windmills.
Grain: grain cards on fields.
Fields: grain fields.
Money: Add 5pt for every 3 money in hand.

The player with the most victory points wins.

Acknowledgement

Thank you to our patient playtesters: Sally Nichols, Steve Wood, and Laurie Wood.

Appendix

WHEAT

exactly 2 of a kind

2 dice must have the same number of pips. 3 or 4 of a kind do not count.

✅ 1, 3, 3, 4 ❌ 4, 4, 4, 5

BUCKWHEAT

run of 3

3 dice can be arranged in ascending order, incrementing by 1. e,g, 1, 2, 3.

✅ 1, 2, 3, 6 ❌ 1, 2, 4, 5

SPELT

any 2 add to 7

Any 2 dice can be summed to make 7.

✅ 2, 3, 4, 6 ❌ 3, 5, 5, 6

OATS

w + x = y + z

You can group dice into 2 groups of 2 such that the sum of the pips of each group is the same.

✅ 3, 4, 5, 6 ❌ 1, 3, 5, 6

BARLEY

all dice > 2

All dice have 3 or more pips.

✅ 3, 4, 5, 5 ❌ 1, 5, 5, 6

TEFF

no die is 1 larger than another

No die is exactly 1 pip bigger or smaller than any other.

✅ 1, 1, 3, 6 ❌ 1, 3, 5, 6

RYE

any 3 add to 10 or 11

The sum of any 3 dice is 10 or 11.

✅ 1, 3, 5, 6 ❌ 1, 2, 5, 6

QUINOA

all different

No 2 dice are the same.

✅ 1, 2, 4, 6 ❌ 2, 3, 4, 4

SORGHUM

3 of a kind

3 dice must have the same number of pips. 2 or 4 of a kind do not count.

✅ 5, 5, 5, 6 ❌ 1, 1, 2, 2

KHORASAN

4 of a kind or 2 sets of 2 of a kind

4 dice must have the same number of pips OR 2 groups of two must have have the same number of pipe.

✅ 1, 1, 5, 5 ❌ 1, 1, 1, 2

FARRO

max - min ≤ 3

The difference between the largest die and the smallest must be 3 or less.

✅ 2, 2, 4, 5 ❌ 1, 1, 4, 5

AMARANTH

no 6s

None of the dice are 6.

✅ 3, 3, 4, 5 ❌ 1, 2, 4, 6

FONIO

any 3 are even

There are 3 or more dice with an even number of pips.

✅ 3, 4, 4, 6 ❌ 1, 2, 4, 5

TRITICALE

2 odd and 2 even dice

There are 2 dice with an even number of pips and 2 dice with odd number of pips.

✅ 3, 2, 4, 5 ❌ 1, 1, 3, 4

BULGUR

any 3 are odd

There are 3 or more dice with an odd number of pips.

✅ 1, 1, 4, 5 ❌ 3, 4, 5, 6

WILD RICE

max - min ≥ 4

The difference between the largest die and the smallest must be 4 or greater.

✅ 1, 1, 4, 5 ❌ 3, 4, 5, 6

EINKORN

any 3 add to ≤ 8

The sum of any 3 dice is 8 or less.

✅ 1, 1, 4, 5 ❌ 3, 4, 5, 6

DURUM

any 2 add to ≥ 10

The sum of any 2 dice is 10 or greater.

✅ 3, 4, 5, 6 ❌ 1, 1, 4, 5